MONTHLY UPDATE

Zimbabwe: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.*

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

The United States embassy said on 25 September that all its health funding to Zimbabwe ends at the end of September. Police traffic cameras have logged more than four million violations, and offenders are being contacted to pay fines. The electronic case management system extends to Midlands and Mashonaland West from 1 October. The ICT minister set a 2030 deadline for more than 250 smart post offices and said an e-commerce bill and a postal policy are being drafted, and a consultative workshop on 21 September took up amendments to the data protection fines instrument.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The ICT minister said on 18 September 2026 that a Postal and Courier Services Policy is being drafted. No draft or date is published. The ICT minister told the regulator to consider a unit to oversee operators' commercial arrangements and enforce active infrastructure sharing.

On World Post Day the ICT minister gave her ministry, the regulator and the postal operator 90 days to produce a costed Postal and Courier Sector Transformation Implementation Plan to 2030, with quarterly progress reports.

Legislation and regulation

Cabinet granted e-hailing platforms a five-month moratorium on 9 September 2026 while a statutory instrument on their operations is prepared. The ICT minister said on 18 September that an E-Commerce and E-Transactions Bill is in preparation; no draft or tabling date is published.

Data protection

The child online protection policy moved to delivery. The ICT minister told the National Assembly on 9 September that content gateways are being installed on public free Wi-Fi and in schools, with teacher and parent training, under an implementation committee with two other ministries.

On 21 September the regulator held a consultative workshop on amendments to SI 155 that would set administrative fines; the amendment text is not on file.

Regional collaboration

On 21 September POTRAZ, which holds the second vice-presidency of the Network of African Data Protection Authorities, marked the first Africa Data Protection Day with a call for privacy-by-design; the network has 34 member authorities.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Planning moved a generation further out. The ICT ministry's permanent secretary was appointed to the parliamentary body planning a thirty-year national roadmap to 2056, which the ministry presents as putting the sector at the centre of long-term national planning. No terms of reference, membership list, work programme or output for the committee is held, and the roadmap itself does not yet exist - so what is established is a seat at a table, not a plan.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The largest operator will shut down its 3G network by the end of December 2027, its chief executive said in an account of 10 September, retiring 3G before 2G because 2G remains widely used in rural areas.

Energy

The listed tower company reported a 30% reduction in fuel consumption for the half year to 31 August 2026, credited to site solarisation, its fuel management system, battery cycling and better grid availability together. It gives no figure for any one of these alone. Construction of the first phase of its planned 100MW solar farm began in the same period.

Cybersecurity

An industrial automation firm announced on 1 September 2026 the completion of a security and modernisation project on the control networks of a platinum mine, covering network architecture, segmentation and controlled access.

DPI

Data Exchange

Customs data crossed a border on paper this month, in the form of an agreement to stop it having to. Customs administrations from five countries adopted a roadmap and action plan for customs-to-customs data exchange at a meeting in Pretoria ending 26 August, to exchange trade information before consignments reach the border so that documentation and risk assessment happen earlier, building on a link this country already runs with Zambia. Data standards, interoperability, cybersecurity, legal authority and information quality are all recorded as unresolved, and no corridor or target crossing time is named.

The registry check reached the wallets. The central bank shut down ghost, fictitious and duplicate mobile money wallets after linking the civil registry's national database with subscriber records; no count of closed wallets is published.

Digital Payments and Fintech

The World Bank warned that the tax on intermediated money transfers discourages digital transactions, weakens intermediation and pushes activity toward cash, as banks and businesses press for its abolition. No government response is recorded.

The stock exchange launched InvoiceX, an invoice-discounting marketplace under its entrepreneurship exchange, reported on 24 September: financiers bid for buyer-authenticated invoices of US$1,000 to US$1.5m and suppliers are to be paid within 48 hours for fees of 0.65 per cent. Whether financing is with recourse is not stated. The central bank governor said it is negotiating to build a real-time payments system on India's UPI technology, with an agreement possible by 31 October 2026. The system's parent bank said Zimbabwe is processing US$5.8m a month through the pan-African payment and settlement system.

Registries

The justice minister told Parliament on 9 September that when the 24-month validation period for securitised deeds ends in July 2027, the Digital Land Administrative Platform becomes the sole authoritative property register and unvalidated paper deeds cannot be used in formal transfers, at a validation fee of US$215.

Sectoral management information systems

The health ministry said its laboratory information management system runs at 117 main laboratories, against a 2030 target of 80% of facilities, with results sent electronically including by SMS. The electronic case management system went live in Midlands and Mashonaland West on 1 October 2026. The home affairs minister told the National Assembly the police are piloting a crime management system built by a state technology institute at Warren Park and other stations.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The ICT minister set a 2030 deadline on 18 September 2026 for turning more than 250 post offices into technology-driven service centres, under a three-phase plan; no cost or site schedule is published.

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

A company partnering the postal operator reported at a conference, reported 9 October 2026, that it has set up 28 nurse-staffed digital health sites in post offices and modular container clinics, connected by satellite and a state mobile operator, and reached 118,000 people.

Technology

AI

The first indigenous-language models in service are commercial rather than national. The dominant operator's artificial-intelligence subsidiary is phasing in a Ndebele-speaking customer-support assistant from September, trained on thousands of hours of recorded Ndebele speech, alongside a Shona assistant it says already resolves more than 70% of enquiries. The resolution rate is the operator's own, and no dataset, evaluation, error rate or escalation route is published. What matters for the record is where the corpora sit: outside the indigenous-language programme the state has committed to and whose ring-fenced share is still unstated.

Innovation ecosystem

The Civil Aviation Authority of Zimbabwe approved Drone Solutions Zimbabwe to fly beyond-visual-line-of-sight deliveries of vaccines, blood, samples and medicines daily, after a demonstration programme completed in August; the approval was reported on 22 September without its own date.

Capacity

Training and skills

The youth ministry, UNDP and a training firm opened a solar-powered digital and AI hub with satellite connectivity at the Nyamuroro vocational training centre in Gokwe, enrolling 50 young people in a free one-year bootcamp from September and targeting 3,000 school learners and 300 teachers. No budget has been published.

Research institutions

The regulator opened a national digital technologies policy research programme with the research council and the industrial research centre, inviting proposals on AI governance, data sovereignty and platform regulation by 3 October. No grant size or number of awards is stated.

Inclusion

Access to services

A larger round of the regulator's disability training ran, and it reached teachers rather than learners: a five-day workshop at Chiredzi for 37 teachers with visual impairments and their assistants and aides, drawn from all ten provinces, covering assistive technologies and accessible digital platforms, facilitated with the same civil-society internet chapter as the June cohort. The Act that would give any of this a statutory footing was passed in November 2025 and still awaits commencement.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The embassy said on 25 September that all US funding for the country's health programmes ends at the end of the month.

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